

Word family: **regular / regularly / regularity / irregular / irregularly / irregularity**

Base word: regular

Related forms: regularly, regularity, irregular, irregularly, irregularity

Part of speech: adjective (形容詞) / noun (名詞 , 部分用法) / related adverb and noun forms (相關副詞及名詞)

Your sentence:

> “Even people who are not **regular readers** seem to know its name.”

Meaning in this passage

Here, **regular** means **doing something frequently and as a normal habit**.

A **regular reader** is someone who reads often and consistently, not just occasionally.

繁體中文： **經常做某件事、把它當成固定習慣的；經常性的**

中文翻譯：

> “Even people who are not **regular readers** seem to know its name.”

「甚至連平時不是**經常閱讀的人**，好像也知道這本書的名字。」

Here:

regular reader = 經常閱讀、把閱讀當成固定習慣的人

1. **regular = happening repeatedly at expected intervals (時間 / 頻率) — 定期的；規律的**

Meaning: Happening again and again at fairly fixed or expected times.

Practice 1

> “We have **regular** meetings every Friday.”

「我們每星期五都有**定期**會議。」

Practice 2

> “The bus runs at **regular** intervals.”

「巴士按**固定間隔**行駛。」

****regular = 按固定或大致穩定的時間間隔重複發生的****

Common:

- * regular meeting
- * regular check
- * regular exercise
- * regular interval
- * regular schedule

2. ****regular = habitual / frequent (習慣) — 經常的 ; 固定習慣的****

This is the meaning used in your passage.

****Meaning:**** Doing or experiencing something often and habitually.

Practice 3 — Original

> “Even people who are not ****regular readers**** seem to know its name.”

「即使不是****經常閱讀的人****，好像也知道它的名字。」

Practice 4

> “She is a ****regular**** customer at the café.”

「她是那間咖啡店的****常客****。」

Practice 5

> “He is a ****regular**** visitor to the library.”

「他是圖書館的****常客 / 經常到訪者****。」

****regular + person = 經常參與、到訪或做某件事的人****

This is closely related to Meaning 1, but the focus is on ****habitual behaviour****, not scheduled timing.

3. ****regular = normal / ordinary / standard (一般) — 普通的 ; 一般的 ; 標準的****

Regular can mean normal, usual, or not special.

Practice 6

> “I ordered a **regular** coffee.”

「我點了一杯**普通 / 標準份量的咖啡**。」

Practice 7

> “This is the **regular** version, not the premium one.”

「這是**普通版**，不是高級版。」

regular = 屬於一般、標準、普通類別，而不是特殊、加強或例外版本的

Common:

- * regular price
- * regular size
- * regular version
- * regular service

This is a major distinct everyday sense.

4. **regular** = orderly / even / uniform (形狀 / 排列) — 規則的；整齊的

Regular can describe shapes, patterns, spacing, or structure that follow a consistent form.

Practice 8

> “The tiles were arranged in a **regular** pattern.”

「瓷磚排列成**規則整齊的圖案**。」

Practice 9

> “The building has a **regular** geometric shape.”

「這棟建築有一個**規則的幾何形狀**。」

regular = 形狀、排列或結構遵循一致規律，沒有明顯變化或不整齊

This is a distinct structural sense.

5. **regular** = following the usual rules/system (文法 / 制度) — 規則的 ; 正常的

In grammar and other rule-based systems, **regular** means following the usual pattern.

Practice 10

> “‘Walk’ is a **regular** verb.”

「walk 是一個**規則動詞**。」

Practice 11

> “The plural follows the **regular** pattern.”

「這個複數形式遵循**規則變化**。」

regular = 按照一般規則或標準模式變化，而不是例外形式

This is a major domain-specific use.

6. **regular** = official/permanent member of a group or force (正式成員) — 正規的 ; 正式的

Regular can describe someone who belongs officially or permanently to an organization, team, military force, etc.

Practice 12

> “He became a **regular** member of the team.”

「他成為球隊的**正式固定成員**。」

Practice 13

> “The unit is part of the **regular** army.”

「該部隊屬於**正規軍**。」

regular = 正式、固定、屬於主要制度或編制之內的

This is distinct from simply “frequent.”

7. **regular** = consistent bodily function (身體) — 規律的 ; 正常的

Regular can describe bodily functions happening normally and consistently.

Practice 14

> “Exercise can help keep your sleep pattern **regular**.”

「運動有助保持睡眠規律**正常**。」

Practice 15

> “Her heartbeat was slow but **regular**.”

「她的心跳雖慢，但很**規律**。」

regular = 身體功能按穩定、正常節奏運作的

For core counting, I would usually merge this with Meaning 1/4 under **stable recurring pattern**, but it is useful to show explicitly.

8. **regular** = usual person/customer/member (名詞) — 常客 ; 固定成員

As a noun, **a regular** can mean someone who frequently goes to a place or participates in something.

Practice 16

> “He is one of the café’s **regulars**.”

「他是那間咖啡店的其中一位**常客**。」

Practice 17

> “Most of the **regulars** knew each other.”

「大部分**熟客 / 常客**彼此都認識。」

a regular = 經常光顧某地或參與某項活動的人

This is a noun development from Meaning 2.

Related form: **regularly**

Regularly means either at consistent intervals or frequently.

Practice 18

> “She exercises **regularly**.”

「她**定期 / 經常**做運動。」

Practice 19

> “The equipment is checked **regularly**.”

「設備會**定期**檢查。」

regularly = 按固定規律，或經常性地

Related form: **regularity**

Regularity means the quality of being regular, repeated, or orderly.

Practice 20

> “The **regularity** of the pattern is easy to see.”

「這個圖案的**規律性**很容易看出來。」

Practice 21

> “Exercise with some **regularity**.”

「要保持一定的**規律性**做運動。」

regularity = 重複、整齊、穩定或有規律的特性

Related form: **irregular**

Irregular is the main opposite.

**irregular = not following a regular pattern (不規則的) **

Practice 22

> “The heartbeat became **irregular**.”

「心跳變得**不規律**。」

Practice 23

> “‘Go’ is an **irregular** verb.”

「go 是一個**不規則動詞**。」

irregular = 不按正常、固定或標準模式發生 / 變化的

Important distinction: **regular vs usual**

usual

means what normally happens or what someone normally does.

regular

often adds the idea of:

- * repetition
- * consistency
- * fixed pattern

> usual breakfast

= 平常吃的早餐

> regular exercise

= 規律運動

Important distinction: **regular vs normal**

normal

means typical or expected.

regular

can mean normal, but often also means repeated or patterned.

> normal temperature

> regular schedule

So they overlap only partly.

Important distinction: **regular vs frequent**

frequent

means happening often.

regular

means happening often **and/or according to a stable pattern**.

Something can be frequent but irregular.

For example:

> frequent interruptions

may happen often but unpredictably.

Important distinction: **regular vs steady**

steady

emphasizes consistency without sudden change.

regular

emphasizes repeated pattern or standard form.

> steady speed

> regular intervals

Different focus.

Important distinction: **regular vs ordinary**

ordinary

means not special or unusual.

regular

can mean ordinary, especially in commercial/product contexts, but also carries many other senses.

> ordinary person

> regular size

Not always interchangeable.

Important distinction: **regular vs standard**

standard

means established as a norm, specification, or benchmark.

regular

in product/service contexts can mean the normal/default version.

> standard procedure

> regular coffee

Different typical collocations.

Important distinction: **regular vs irregular**

This contrast changes slightly by domain:

* regular schedule ↔ irregular schedule

* regular verb ↔ irregular verb

* regular heartbeat ↔ irregular heartbeat

* regular pattern ↔ irregular pattern

The underlying contrast is:

> **follows a stable or expected pattern**

> versus

> **does not**

Countability note

As an adjective, countability does not apply.

As a noun:

> a regular

> several regulars

means a frequent customer/participant.

Family-extension note

The practical modern family includes:

* **regular**

* **regularly**

* **regularity**

* **irregular**

* **irregularly**

* **irregularity**

Useful constructions include:

* regular reader

* regular customer

* regular meeting

* regular interval

* regular size

* regular pattern

* regular verb

* regular army

* regular heartbeat

The Golden Manual says grammatical and domain-specific uses should be checked, while closely

related contexts should be merged whenever the same underlying pattern concept still works.

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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regular — repeated/scheduled	按固定或穩定時間 / 次序重複發生的；定期、規律的
regular — habitual person/activity	經常進行某活動、到訪某地或把某事當成習慣的
regular — normal/standard	一般、普通、標準版本的；不是特殊或例外的
regular — orderly/uniform	形狀、排列或結構按一致規律形成的；規則的
regular — grammatical/system rule	按一般規則或標準模式變化的
regular — official/permanent	屬於正式、固定編制或主要制度內的
a regular	經常光顧某地或參與某項活動的人；常客
regularly	定期地；有規律地；經常地
irregular	不按固定、正常或標準模式發生 / 變化的

For your original sentence

> “Even people who are not ****regular readers**** seem to know its name.”

The exact meaning is:

****regular = 經常閱讀、把閱讀當成固定習慣的****

So:

> ****regular reader****

= ****經常看書的人 / 有固定閱讀習慣的人****

For your database, I would count ****6 genuinely useful core meanings**** for ****regular****:

1. ****happening repeatedly at stable intervals****
2. ****habitual/frequent — regular customer/reader****
3. ****normal/default/standard version****
4. ****orderly or uniform in shape/pattern****
5. ****following normal grammatical/system rules****
6. ****official/permanent member or force****

I would merge bodily regularity into #1/#4, treat noun ****a regular**** as a grammatical extension of #2, and keep ****regularly / regularity / irregular**** as family extensions rather than inflate the count.